

B:3

I vow to thee, my country

Arranged by Bridget Mermikides

Gustav Holst
(1874–1934)

Moderato ♩ = c.63

i m i

I

mf

II

mp legato

5

p

9

pp

This well-known melody was originally a theme in 'Jupiter, the bringer of Jollity', from the orchestral suite *The Planets*, written between 1914 and 1916 by the British composer Gustav Holst. In 1921, Holst was asked to make a song setting of 'I vow to thee, my country', a patriotic poem by the late diplomat Sir Cecil Arthur Spring Rice. He fitted the poem to a slightly adapted version of his 'Jupiter' tune. Later, in 1926, Holst arranged the song as a hymn for the hymn book *Songs of Praise*, and it became widely known in this form. Since 1991, it has reached a different audience as 'The world in union', the theme song of international rugby union. **In the exam, the candidate should play part I.**

13

mf

f

mp

Detailed description: This system contains measures 13 through 16. The right-hand staff (treble clef) begins with a mezzo-forte (mf) dynamic. It features a melodic line with eighth and quarter notes, ending with a crescendo hairpin leading to a forte (f) dynamic in the final measure. The left-hand staff (treble clef) provides harmonic support with chords and single notes, starting at mezzo-piano (mp) and ending with a crescendo hairpin.

17

mf

mp

p

Detailed description: This system contains measures 17 through 20. The right-hand staff continues the melodic line, ending with a mezzo-piano (mp) dynamic. The left-hand staff features a series of chords, starting at mezzo-forte (mf) and ending with a piano (p) dynamic.

21

rit.

Detailed description: This system contains measures 21 through 24. The right-hand staff begins with a melodic line, and the word 'rit.' (ritardando) is written above the staff. The left-hand staff provides harmonic support with chords and single notes. The system concludes with a double bar line.